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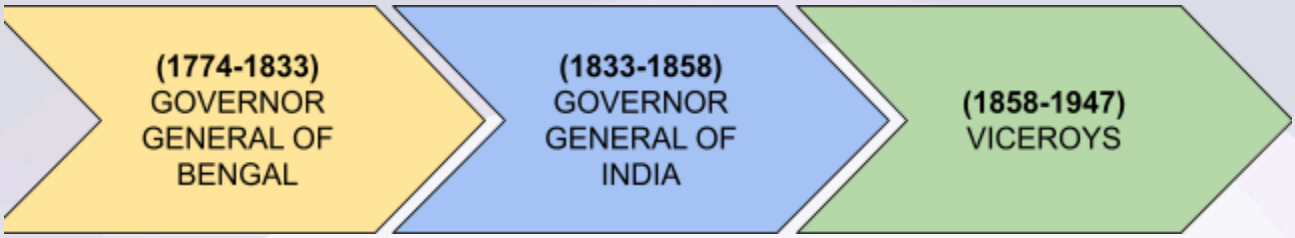
General Knowledge
Modern History

STUDY NOTES

Viceroys & Governors

VICEROYS AND GOVERNORS



Governor-General of Bengal (1773-1858)

Warren Hastings (1772-1785)

- Became Governor of Bengal in 1772 and then 1 Governor General of Bengal through the Regulating Act of 1773.
- The Supreme Court at Fort William was established in 1774.
- Act of 1781, under which the powers of jurisdiction between the governor-general in-council and the Supreme Court at Calcutta, were clearly divided.
- Pitt's India Act of 1784.
- Strained relationships with Chait Singh, the Maharaja of Benaras, led to Warren Hastings' impeachment in England.
- Founded the Asiatic Society of Bengal (1784) with William Jones.

Lord Cornwallis (1786-1793)

- Known as the **"father of civil services In India"** because of the Europeanisation of administrative machinery and the introduction of civil services.
- Established appellate courts, lower-grade courts, and Sanskrit College.
- Fought the Third Anglo-Mysore War and signed the Treaty of Seringapatam.
- Introduced Permanent Settlement and civil services.

Sir John Shore (1793-1798)

- Passed the Charter Act of 1793.
- Policy of Non-intervention; involved in the Battle of Kharda.

Lord Wellesley (1798-1805)

- Original Name: Richard Colley Wellesley, 1st Marquess Wellesley
- Introduced the Subsidiary Alliance System.

- Fought the Fourth Anglo-Mysore War and signed the Treaty of Bassein; Second Anglo-Maratha War.
- Established Fort William College at Calcutta in 1800.
- Madras' Presidency was formed during his tenure in 1801.

Sir George Barlow (1805-1807)

- Acting Governor-General until Lord Minto arrived.
- Notable for the Mutiny of Vellore (1806).

Lord Minto I (1807-1813)

- Concluded the Treaty of Amritsar with Maharaja Ranjit Singh (1809).
- Introduced the Charter Act of 1813.

Lord Hastings (1813-1823)

- Ended the policy of Non-intervention and adopted the policy of intervention and war.
- Fought the Anglo-Nepal War (1814-1816); signed the Treaty of Sagauli.
- Abolished Peshwaship
- Strife with Pindaris (1817-1818) and complete destruction of the Pindari Clan in India.
- Creation of Bombay presidency in 1818.
- Establishment of the Ryotwari System by Thomas Munro, governor of Madras (1820) and Mahalwari System in Northern India (1822).

Lord Amherst (1823-1828)

- Annexed Assam
- Establishment of Sanskrit College at Calcutta (1824).
- First Burmese War (1824-1826) and Treaty of Yandabo (1826) Acquisition of territories of Malay Peninsula.
- Capture of Bharatpur (1826).

Governor-General of India (1833-1858)

Lord William Bentinck (1828-1835)

- Most liberal and enlightened Governor General of India.
- Suppression of Thugi (1830).
- Charter Act of 1833: It provided that no Indian subject of the Company would be
- debarred from holding an office on account of his religion, place of birth, descent and colour.
- Regarded as the **"father of modern Western education in India."**
- First Governor-General of India as per the Charter Act of 1833.
- Abolished Sati and suppressed Thugee, infanticide, and child sacrifices.
- Proposed the English Education Act of 1835; established Medical College and Hospital in Kolkata.

Lord Charles Metcalfe (1835-1836)

- New press law removing restrictions on the press in India were passed by him.
- Repealed Licensing Regulation of 1823.
- Known as **the "liberator of the press in India."**
- Established Calcutta Public Library in 1836.

Lord Auckland (1836-1842)

- Improved domestic schools; expanded the commercial industry in India.
- Initiated the First Anglo-Afghan War.

Lord Ellenborough (1842-1844)

- Annexed Sindh.
- Death of Ranjit Singh (1839) during his tenure.
- Tripartite Treaty in 1838 between the British, Shah Shuja and Ranjit Singh against Dost Muhammad Khan.
- First Afghan War (1838-42). This was a great blow to the prestige of the British in India.
- **Bank of Bombay was established in 1840. (This later became Imperial Bank of India and now SBI).**

Lord Hardinge I (1844-1848)

- First Anglo-Sikh War.

Lord Dalhousie (1848-1856)

- James Andrew Brown Ramsay introduced significant reforms and initiatives during his tenure.
- He oversaw the establishment of the first railway line connecting Bombay and Thane in 1853 under the Railway Minute of 1853.
- He laid 4000 miles of telegraph lines to connect Calcutta, Bombay, Madras, and Peshawar to enhance communication.
- The Post Office Act was introduced in 1854, reforming the postal system.
- The Ganges Canal was declared open in 1854, marking a milestone in irrigation infrastructure.
- He established separate Public Works Departments in every province to improve infrastructure development.
- He played a significant role in the Second Anglo-Sikh War and introduced the Doctrine of Lapse.
- He implemented Wood's Dispatch in 1854, which became a cornerstone for modern education policies in India.
- His efforts in railway development led to the establishment of the first railway line from Bombay to Thane in 1853.
- The Indian Post Office Act institutionalized a uniform postal system.

Lord Canning (1856-1857)

- Established the universities at Calcutta, Madras, and Bombay.
- A key figure during the Revolt of 1857.

Viceroys of India (1858-1947)

Lord Canning (1856-1862)

- First Viceroy of India; oversaw the Revolt of 1857.
- Till 1858 served as Governor General of India and after 1858, served as Viceroy of India.
- Government of India Act 1858 was passed as an Act of Good Governance in India.
- White Mutiny' by European troops in 1859.
- Indian Council Act of 1861 was passed.
- The System of Budget and Portfolio System was introduced.

- Abolished the East India Company; and transferred power to the British Crown (Government of India Act, 1858).

Lord Elgin (1862-1863)

- Handled the Wahhabi Movement.

Lord John Lawrence (1864-1869)

- Established High Courts in Calcutta, Bombay, and Madras.
- Engaged in the Anglo-Bhutanese War.

Lord Mayo (1869-1872)

- The introduced financial distribution between the centre and states.
- Conducted the **first Census in 1872**; established Mayo College for the royal elite.
- Killed by Sher Ali Afridi in Port Blair.

Lord Northbrook (1872-1876)

- Introduced Civil Marriage and Arya Samaj marriage.
- Allowed intercaste marriage; noted for the Kuka Movement in Punjab.

Lord Lytton (1876-1880)

- Introduced the Vernacular Press Act and Arms Act.
- Oversaw severe famine and organized a Durbar; proclaimed Queen Victoria as the Empress of India.
- Abolished the cotton tax; lowered civil services exam age limit.

Lord Ripon (1880-1884)

- Repealed the controversial Arms and Vernacular Press Acts.
- Established local self-governments (Panchayats and Municipal Boards); known as the Father of Self-Government.
- Set up two new universities: Punjab University (1884) and Allahabad University (1887).
- Introduced the Illbert Bill; appointed the Hunter Commission.
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Lord Dufferin (1884-1888)

- Oversaw the Third Anglo-Burmese War (1885-1886).
- Founded the Indian National Congress in 1885.

Lord Lansdowne (1888-1894)

- Introduced the Indian Councils Act of 1892; initiated indirect elections.
- Passed the Factory Act (1891).

Lord Elgin II (1894-1899)

- The First British officer was killed in India (Rands, by the Chapekar brothers).
- Noted for political unrest.

Lord Curzon (1899-1905)

- Introduced the Indian Universities Act; partitioned Bengal (1905).
- Engaged in the Curzon-Kitchener controversy; appointed the Raleigh Commission.

Lord Minto II (1905-1910)

- Introduced the Morley-Minto Reforms; and addressed the Swadeshi Movement.
- Established the Muslim League.

Lord Hardinge II (1910-1916)

- Annulled the Partition of Bengal; transferred the capital from Calcutta to Delhi.
- Established the Hindu Mahasabha.

Lord Chelmsford (1916-1921)

- Involved in the Home Rule League Movements; passed the Rowlatt Act.
- Introduced the Montague-Chelmsford reforms; faced the Jallianwala Bagh massacre.

Lord Reading (1921-1926)

- Established the Swaraj Party; witnessed the Chauri Chaura incident.

Lord Irwin (1926-1931)

- Launched the Civil Disobedience Movement and Dandi March.
- Hosted the First Round Table Conference.

Lord Willingdon (1931-1936)

- Conducted the Second and Third Round Table Conferences.
- Signed the Poona Pact and initiated the Communal Award.

Lord Linlithgow (1936-1944)

- Managed the Cripps Mission; oversaw the Quit India Movement.

Lord Wavell (1944-1947)

- Introduced the CR Formula (1944); and organized the Shimla Conference.
- Announced the launch of Direct Action Day.

Lord Mountbatten (1947-1948)

- Proposed the June 3rd Plan; was the last Viceroy and the first Governor-General of independent India.

In the Summarized way:-

Governor-General/Viceroy	Tenure	Key Achievements/Events
Warren Hastings	1772-1785	- First Governor-General of Bengal. - Regulating Act of 1773. - Established the Supreme Court. - First English translation of the Bhagavad Gita. - Treaty of Salbai (First Anglo-Maratha War).
Lord Cornwallis	1786-1793	- End dual administration. - Permanent Settlement; fought Third Anglo-Mysore War. - Established appellate courts.
Sir John Shore	1793-1798	- Charter Act of 1793. - Non-intervention policy; Battle of Kharda.

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Lord Wellesley	1798-1805	- Subsidiary Alliance System. - Fought Fourth Anglo-Mysore War; Treaty of Bassein. - Established Fort William College.
Sir George Barlow	1805-1807	- Acting Governor-General. - Mutiny of Vellore (1806).
Lord Minto I	1807-1813	- Treaty of Amritsar with Maharaja Ranjit Singh (1809). - Charter Act of 1813.
Lord Hastings	1813-1823	- End Non-intervention policy. - First Anglo-Nepal War; Treaty of Sagauli.
Lord Amherst	1823-1828	- Annexed Assam; initiated First Burmese War (1824).
Lord William Bentinck	1828-1835	- Abolished Sati and Thuggee. - Proposed English Education Act of 1835.
Lord Charles Metcalfe	1835-1836	- Liberator of the Indian Press; withdrew press restrictions.
Lord Auckland	1836-1842	- First Anglo-Afghan War; improved domestic schools.
Lord Ellenborough	1842-1844	- Annexed Sindh.
Lord Hardinge I	1844-1848	- First Anglo-Sikh War.
Lord Dalhousie	1848-1856	- Second Anglo-Sikh War; introduced the Doctrine of Lapse. - Wood's Dispatch (1854).
Lord Canning	1856-1857	- First Viceroy; oversaw the Revolt of 1857. - Abolished East India Company.
Lord Elgin	1862-1863	- Handled the Wahhabi Movement.
Lord John Lawrence	1864-1869	- Established High Courts; engaged in the Anglo-Bhutanese War.
Lord Mayo	1869-1872	- Introduced financial distribution; conducted the first Census in 1872.
Lord Northbrook	1872-1876	- Introduced Civil Marriage; allowed intercaste marriage.
Lord Lytton	1876-1880	- Introduced the Vernacular Press Act; proclaimed Queen

		Victoria as Empress.
Lord Ripon	1880-1884	- Repealed Arms and Vernacular Press Acts; established local self-government.
Lord Dufferin	1884-1888	- Oversaw the Third Anglo-Burmese War; founded Indian National Congress (1885).
Lord Lansdowne	1888-1894	- Introduced Indian Councils Act of 1892; initiated indirect elections.
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Lord Reading	1921-1926	- Established Swaraj Party; witnessed the Chauri Chaura incident.
Lord Irwin	1926-1931	- Launched Civil Disobedience Movement; hosted the First Round Table Conference.
Lord Willingdon	1931-1936	- Conducted Second and Third Round Table Conferences; signed Poona Pact.
Lord Linlithgow	1936-1944	- Managed Cripps Mission; oversaw Quit India Movement.
Lord Wavell	1944-1947	- Introduced CR Formula; organized Shimla Conference.
Lord Mountbatten	1947-1948	- Proposed June 3rd Plan; last Viceroy and first Governor-General of independent India.

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